

Lessons-Learned Report

Author: Rahul Shankar

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Project Name: PMS Comparison

Project Sponsor: ECMS Program Sponsor

Project Manager: Matthew Rushmer

Project Dates: 30/07/2026 – 23/08/2026

Final Budget: Approved budget of NZD \$200,000 (actual final cost not available)

1. Did the project meet scope, time, and cost goals?

If not, explain:

The project mostly met its scope and time goals. The team kept the project focused on comparing two cloud-based Project Management Systems and worked towards the requirements set out in the project documents. The work for Part 1 was completed by the required submission deadline.

The cost goal is harder to fully measure because our project documents mainly contain the planned budget and financial estimates rather than the actual amount spent. Because of this, we can say that the project was planned around the approved budget, but we cannot accurately confirm the final actual cost.

2. What was the success criteria listed in the project scope statement?

The success criteria were:

- Time: The PMS Comparison Wiki must be completed and ready for use by the agreed project deadline.
- Scope: The Wiki must compare exactly two cloud-based PMS platforms, cover all five project management process groups, remain within the 4,500-word limit, and not select Microsoft Project as one of the two platforms.
- Stakeholder: The final Wiki should be reviewed by the relevant ECMS/R&D stakeholder before release, and any important feedback should be addressed before the Wiki is considered complete.

3. Reflect on whether or not you met the project success criteria.

Overall, the team made good progress towards the success criteria. The project stayed within the agreed scope by focusing on two cloud-based PMS platforms and using the five project management process groups as the basis of the comparison. The team also monitored the 4,500-word limit throughout the project.

The time goal was achieved for the Part 1 submission, although some individual tasks were delayed during the project. Stakeholder involvement was also maintained through meetings and feedback from the TA/client contact. This feedback helped the team identify problems that needed to be corrected before submission.

One thing we learned is that meeting the final deadline does not necessarily mean that every part of the project went according to schedule. Some decisions and documents were delayed during the earlier weeks, which created more work closer to the deadline.

4. What were the main lessons your team learned from this project?

One of the main lessons was the importance of keeping absent team members updated. Bradley missed the kick-off meeting and was not properly briefed straight away. Because of this, a later meeting had to be used to explain his tasks instead of completing other planned work. The TA specifically pointed out that a short handover after the kick-off meeting could have prevented this delay.

Another lesson was that every task should have a clear deadline. Earlier in the project, some tasks were marked as “ongoing.” The TA pointed out that “ongoing” was not a proper due date. This showed us that clear dates make it easier to track whether work is actually on schedule.

We also learned that meetings are more effective when the team comes prepared to make decisions. The PMS finalist decision was carried over between meetings because we had not prepared enough options beforehand. In future, research should be completed before the meeting so the meeting can be used to make the final decision rather than create another action item.

5. Describe one example of what went right on this project.

One thing that went well was the final review process. Near the end of Part 1, the team reviewed the progress of all project documents, checked the Risk and Issue Registers, and reviewed formatting and consistency across the submission. Each member was also given responsibility for completing and proofreading their own documents before the final meeting.

This worked well because everyone knew what they were responsible for and there was a final opportunity to identify mistakes before submission. It showed that assigning clear ownership and having a final review meeting can improve the quality of the finished work.

6. Describe one example of what went wrong on this project.

A problem occurred when Bradley missed the kick-off meeting and was not properly updated afterwards. He had been assigned the Issue Register and Milestone Report, but he had not received enough explanation about what he needed to do. As a result, the 6 August meeting was mainly spent bringing him up to date instead of completing the planned PMS finalist work.

This delayed another important project decision. The problem could have been avoided if a short summary of the kick-off meeting and Bradley's assigned responsibilities had been sent to him immediately after the meeting.

7. What will you do differently on the next project based on your experience working on this project?

For the next project, I would improve communication and task tracking from the beginning. If someone misses a meeting, I would send them a short written summary within 24 hours explaining the decisions that were made, their assigned work, and the deadline.

I would also make sure that every task has a specific owner and completion date instead of using terms such as “ongoing.” Before meetings, the team should receive an agenda and complete any required research so that meetings can be used to make decisions rather than repeating unfinished work.

Finally, I would schedule an internal deadline a few days before the actual submission date. This would give the team enough time to proofread the documents, check that dates and figures are consistent, and make sure nothing is missing before submission. The team already found that proofreading and final checks were important near the end of Part 1.